

Derek Wang

+1 (416) 898-6127 | derek.wang1@uwaterloo.ca | [linkedin.com/in/4derekwang](https://www.linkedin.com/in/4derekwang) | github.com/4ppleSA0CE | derekwng.ca

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C++, C, Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL

Technologies: React, FastAPI, Node.js, Next.js, Express, ROS2, PyTorch, OpenCV

Engineering Tools: Git, Fusion 360, Docker, Foxglove, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Supabase

Certifications: Docker Foundations Professional

EXPERIENCE

Autonomous Self Driving Software Engineer

Sept 2025 – Present

WATonomous

Waterloo, ON, Canada

- Architected and deployed a full ROS2 navigation stack (costmaps, A*, Pure Pursuit) enabling autonomous rover path following in dynamic environments
- Led YOLO11s model retraining, improving detection mAP from 30% to 80% across 3,448 labeled images through hyperparameter tuning and augmentation redesign
- Optimized and Deployed YOLO11s to rover hardware at 30 FPS using ONNX export and onnxslim optimization

Autonomy Developer

Aug 2025 – Feb 2026

Waterloo Aerial Robotics Group

Waterloo, ON, Canada

- Developed a Python HITL flight simulation system using MAVLink for the 2026 UAS Student Competition
- Redesigned GPS movement system to eliminate teleportation bugs, enabling smooth trajectory interpolation via periodic position updates

Robotics Software Programmer – VEX Robotics Competition

Sept 2024 – June 2025

Checkmate Robotics Club

Markham, Ontario

- Reduced robot positioning error by 40% using odometry and PID control in competition autonomous routines
- Earned invitation to 2025 VRC Worlds (top 10% globally) and placed 5th/80 at Provincials by designing autonomous routes with motion profiling and path planning

PROJECTS

Silhouette | *Node.js, Next.js, Express, MongoDB, Gemini, Overshoot.ai SDK*

- Built a real-time AI fashion advisor with live camera input at NexHacks, earning a VC referral for Merian Brothers
- Implemented a Next.js + React frontend and Express.js backend with MongoDB Atlas, supporting 3+ style pipelines and dynamic product linking
- Integrated Overshoot.ai and Gemini for live video outfit analysis, handling async inference and rate limiting to return recommendations in under 2s

Hierarchical Reasoning Retrieval | *Node.js, Express, SQLite, Gemini*

- Built an LLM-powered document retrieval system that searches structured documents (contracts, specs) using beam search over heading-based tree structures instead of flat vector similarity
- Implemented a markdown ingestion pipeline with heading-based chunking, tree construction, LLM summarization, and hybrid search combining FTS5 keyword filtering with LLM branch selection

Coffee Chat Scheduler | *React, Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Google Calendar API*

- Built a full-stack booking app with React and FastAPI, integrating Google Calendar via OAuth 2.0 for real-time availability, scheduling 20+ coffee chats
- Stored booking data in PostgreSQL via SQLAlchemy, with automated event creation and availability checking

Autonomous Vehicle Control System | *C++, ROS2, Docker, CMake, Foxglove*

- Built a C++ LiDAR perception pipeline generating real-time occupancy costmaps at 0.1m resolution in Foxglove
- Developed and tested a full ROS2 autonomous navigation system with Docker, validating obstacle avoidance across 50+ simulated scenarios

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

Expected Apr 2030

Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering

GPA: 3.7

- Relevant Coursework:** Linear Algebra, Fundamentals of Programming